

RESEARCH & DATA COMPILATION REPORT

Volunteer Opportunities, Internships & Fellowships for Students in India

A structured resource of 18 opportunities across volunteering, internships and fellowships open to Indian students

PREPARED FOR

Student research & data organisation exercise

CATEGORIES COVERED

Volunteering Programmes | Internships | Fellowships

Compiled from publicly available organisation websites and programme listings.
Verify current deadlines and eligibility on each organisation's official page before applying.

About This Report

This report compiles 18 volunteer opportunities, internships, fellowships and social initiatives open to students in India, organised into three categories: Volunteering Programmes, Internship Programmes, and Fellowships. For each entry, the report lists the organisation name, opportunity type, eligibility criteria, application link and deadline (where available), along with a short note on what the role involves. The objective is to build a practical, easy-to-scan resource students can use to identify and apply to opportunities that match their interests and academic stage.

How to use this report: Opportunities marked "Rolling" accept applications on an ongoing basis; those tied to a specific cycle (e.g. fellowships) should be re-verified on the official website for the current year's exact dates, since NGO and fellowship cycles shift from year to year.

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1. Volunteering Programmes	9
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3. Fellowships	4
Total	18

1. Volunteering Programmes

Structured, low-barrier ways for students to give time to a cause on a weekly, monthly, or one-off basis, both on-ground and remote.

1. National Service Scheme (NSS)

Volunteering (Govt.)

Eligibility Students in Class 11 and above, enrolled through an NSS-affiliated school or college

Application link mybharat.gov.in (registration via NSS Programme Officer)

Deadline Rolling; college-cycle based

India's flagship student volunteering scheme; now integrated with the MY Bharat portal, which also tracks NCC, NYKS and Scouts & Guides participation.

2. Nehru Yuva Kendra Sangathan (NYKS)

Volunteering (Govt.)

Eligibility Youth aged 15-29, whether or not currently enrolled in a formal institution

Application link nyks.gov.in / mybharat.gov.in

Deadline Rolling

Community-level youth clubs run by the Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports across districts nationwide, covering health, environment and civic-awareness drives.

3. iVolunteer

Volunteering platform

Eligibility Students and individuals (18+); no prior experience required

Application link ivolunteer.in

Deadline Rolling

Connects volunteers to vetted NGOs across roughly 20 states, offering both on-ground and remote roles matched to the volunteer's skills.

4. GiveIndia Volunteering Network

Volunteering platform

Eligibility Students and professionals; open registration

Application link giveindia.org

Deadline Rolling

Primarily a donation platform that also links volunteers to a wide network of verified NGOs across causes.

5. Robin Hood Army

Volunteering (hunger relief)

Eligibility Anyone 18+, including college students; time commitment only, no fees

Application link robinhoodarmy.com/join

Deadline Rolling

Collects surplus food from restaurants and distributes it to those in need; volunteers ("Robins") join local city chapters for weekend distribution drives.

6. Goonj*Volunteering & 1-month internship*

Eligibility	College students and graduates from any field
Application link	goonj.org/volunteer-intern
Deadline	Rolling (internship certificate needs 1 month full-time)

Converts urban surplus material into rural development resources; interns work at Goonj's processing centres after a short screening.

7. HelpAge India*Volunteering (elderly welfare)*

Eligibility	Students and members of the public, 18+
Application link	helpageindia.org
Deadline	Rolling

Volunteer support for programmes on elder care, health camps and awareness campaigns run across HelpAge India's regional offices.

8. WWF-India Volunteers Programme*Volunteering (environment)*

Eligibility	Citizens above 18 (students especially encouraged)
Application link	volunteers.wwfindia.org
Deadline	Rolling; project-wise orientation dates

City-based conservation projects (bird walks, awareness drives, clean-up campaigns); for stints under 30 days, this volunteer track is used instead of the internship route.

9. Unessa Foundation*Remote/virtual volunteering*

Eligibility	College students, flexible 2-hour weekly slots
Application link	unessafoundation.org
Deadline	Rolling

Virtual teaching, mentoring and coding workshops for underserved learners; a common entry point for students who want to start online before committing to on-ground work.

2. Internship Programmes

Time-bound, resume-building placements — some paid, some purely experience-based — with NGOs, government bodies and international networks.

1. PM Internship Scheme (PMIS)*Government paid internship*

Eligibility	Indian youth aged 18-25; final-year UG/PG students eligible with an NOC; not in full-time employment
Application link	pminternship.mca.gov.in
Deadline	Rolling portal; each listed internship has its own closing date

Ministry of Corporate Affairs initiative placing candidates with 500+ top companies across sectors; stipend of Rs 9,000/month (Rs 8,100 govt + Rs 900 company) via DBT.

2. CRY (Child Rights and You) Internship*NGO internship (child rights)*

Eligibility	Students and young professionals
Application link	cry.org/volunteering-and-internships
Deadline	Rolling

Roles span advocacy, research, campaigns and fundraising in support of child-rights programming across India.

3. Smile Foundation Internship*NGO internship (education, health, livelihood)*

Eligibility	Students and graduates; typical placement is 1 month
Application link	smilefoundationindia.org/volunteers-interns
Deadline	Rolling

Interns are placed across 11+ functional areas including individual partnerships, HR, IT, and field programme support.

4. WWF-India Internship Programme*NGO internship (conservation)*

Eligibility	Final-year undergraduate and postgraduate students (Indian or foreign institutions)
Application link	wwfindia.org/who_we_are/internship_at_wwf_india
Deadline	Rolling; academic-term based

Structured internships (30+ days) on live conservation projects; a separate track covers environmental-law internships. Stipends are not guaranteed for course-credit interns.

5. AIESEC in India — Global Volunteer / Global Talent*International volunteering & internship exchange*

Eligibility	University students of Indian nationality
Application link	aiesec.in
Deadline	Rolling, cohort-based

Places students in short-term volunteering or internship projects abroad aligned with the UN Sustainable Development Goals; academic-credit partnerships available with some institutions.

3. Fellowships

Longer, more selective leadership-development programmes aimed at graduates and final-year students who want sustained, immersive social-impact experience.

1. Teach For India Fellowship*2-year teaching fellowship*

Eligibility	Graduates (any discipline) completing their degree by June/July 2026; Indian citizens or OCI
Application link	teachforindia.org
Deadline	Cycle-based; recent rounds closed Feb-Mar 2026

Full-time classroom teaching in under-resourced schools alongside leadership training; monthly stipend (~Rs 25,000-30,000) plus housing support and insurance.

2. Gandhi Fellowship (Piramal Foundation)*2-year leadership fellowship***Eligibility** Graduates completing graduation/post-graduation by June 2026**Application link** piramalfoundation.org (Gandhi Fellowship)**Deadline** Cycle-based; check current intake*Immersive rural and semi-urban placements working with communities, government systems and schools to build grassroots leadership.***3. Young India Fellowship (Ashoka University)***1-year postgraduate diploma fellowship***Eligibility** Completed undergraduate degree, or final-year students graduating by summer 2026**Application link** ashoka.edu.in/yif-admissions**Deadline** Multiple application rounds through the admission cycle*Interdisciplinary liberal-arts fellowship; Fellows receive partial-to-full financial support and a post-graduate diploma from Ashoka University.***4. Swagrama Fellowship (Youth for Seva)***Community-leadership fellowship***Eligibility** Young people interested in village-level development work**Application link** youthforseva.org**Deadline** Rolling; check current cohort dates*Cultivates local ownership of village development by embedding fellows with rural communities to build leadership from within.*

Notes & Disclaimer

All information above was gathered from publicly available organisation websites, government scheme portals and programme listings. Stipends, deadlines and eligibility rules for government schemes (such as the PM Internship Scheme) and fellowship cycles (such as Teach For India and Gandhi Fellowship) are revised periodically — always cross-check the official application page before submitting an application.